

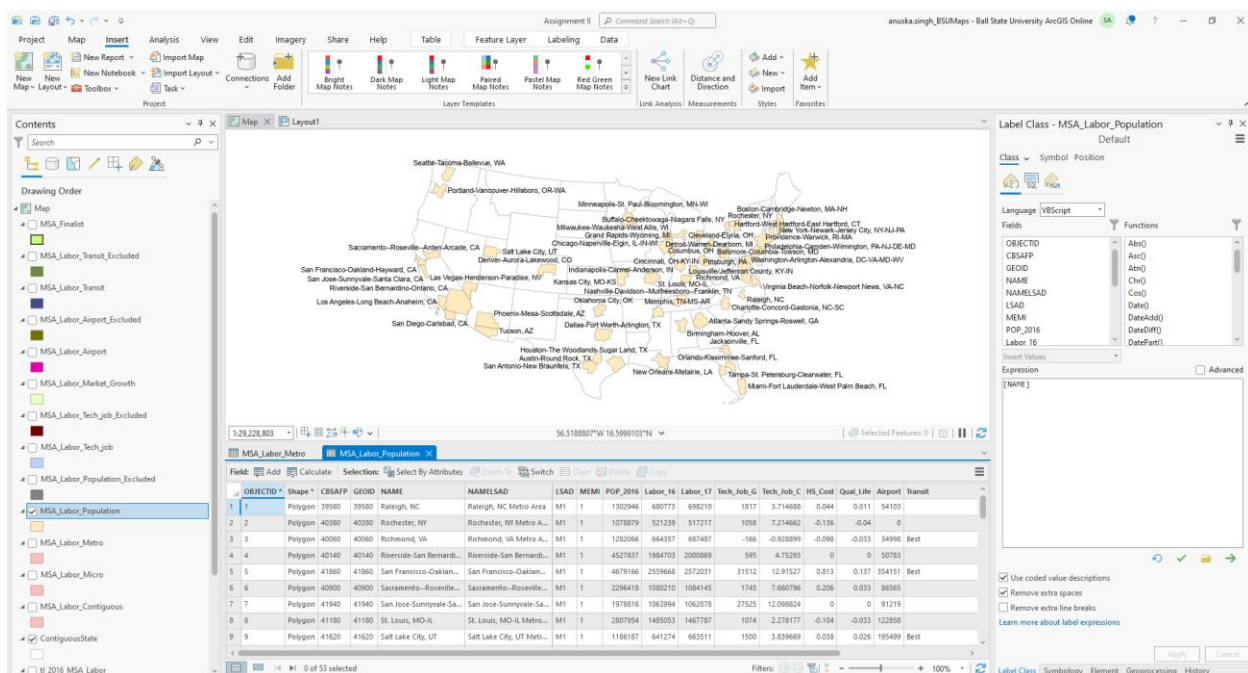
How many Metropolitan Statistical Area (MSA, not micropolitan statistical area, MiSA) are in the 48 contiguous states? How can you answer this question? Which field do you need to use to answer that question?

There are 378 Metropolitan Statistical Area in the 48 contiguous states. I answered this question using “Select by Attribute.” I used the New Selection where LSAD is equal to M1, which designated the Metropolitan Statistical Area (MSA).

1. First Criteria: Population

How many MSAs are selected by the above criteria?

- There are 53 MSAs selected by the population criteria.



2. Second Criteria: Labor market growth

How many MSAs are selected by the above criteria?

- There are 43 MSAs selected by the labor market growth criteria.

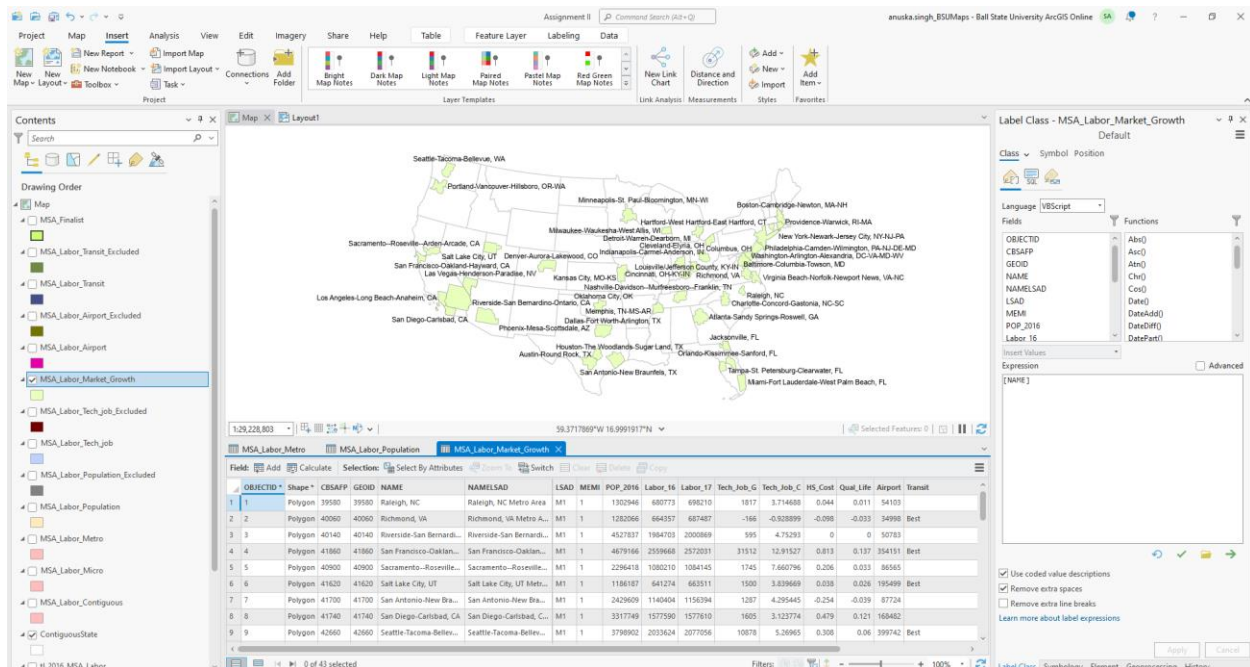
Compare your selection of MSAs with the finalist MSAs on page 1. Which MSAs are not included in your analysis result and why do you think they are excluded? Explain.

- There were 10 MSAs not included in the analysis result:
 - o Rochester, NY Metro Area
 - o San Jose-Sunnyvale-Santa Clara, CA Metro Area
 - o St. Louis, MO-IL Metro Area
 - o Tucson, AZ Metro Area

- New Orleans-Metairie, LA Metro Area
- Pittsburgh, PA Metro Area
- Grand Rapids-Wyoming, MI Metro Area
- Birmingham-Hoover, AL Metro Area
- Buffalo-Cheektowaga-Niagara Falls, NY Metro Area
- Chicago-Naperville-Elgin, IL-IN-WI Metro Area

These MSAs might be excluded from the analysis due to following reasons:

- They likely had a labor force below the required 600,000 thresholds in 2017.
- They did not show positive growth in the labor force between 2016 and 2017, potentially due to economic challenges, high living costs, or demographic shifts.



3. Third Criteria: Tech job

How many MSAs are selected by the above criteria?

- There are 42 MSAs selected by the tech job.

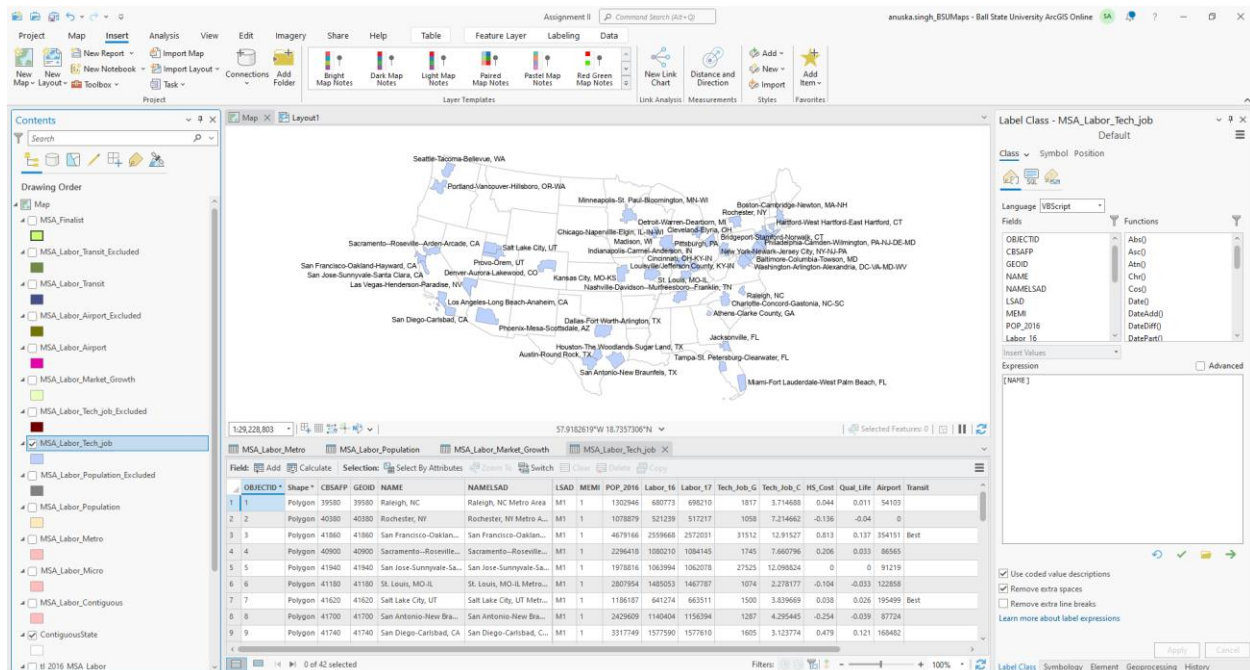
Compare your selection of MSAs with the finalist MSAs on page 1. In this step, which MSAs are not included in your analysis result, and why do you think they are excluded? Explain.

- There are 15 MSAs excluded in the analysis result.:
 - Richmond, VA Metro Area
 - Riverside-San Bernardino-Ontario, CA Metro Area
 - Tucson, AZ Metro Area
 - Virginia Beach-Norfolk-Newport News, VA-NC Metro Area

- New Orleans-Metairie, LA Metro Area
- Oklahoma City, OK Metro Area
- Orlando-Kissimmee-Sanford, FL Metro Area
- Providence-Warwick, RI-MA Metro Area
- Memphis, TN-MS-AR Metro Area
- Milwaukee-Waukesha-West Allis, WI Metro Area
- Grand Rapids-Wyoming, MI Metro Area
- Atlanta-Sandy Springs-Roswell, GA Metro Area
- Birmingham-Hoover, AL Metro Area
- Buffalo-Cheektowaga-Niagara Falls, NY Metro Area
- Columbus, OH Metro Area

They might be excluded due to following reasons:

- The MSAs did not meet the required total number of labor ($\geq 600,000$ in 2017).
- The change in the total number of labors between 2016 and 2017 was not positive.
- The MSAs did not have a tech job growth greater than 1,000 between 2013 and 2015.
- The percent change in tech jobs was not positive between 2013 and 2015.
- Seattle, WA was explicitly excluded from the analysis.



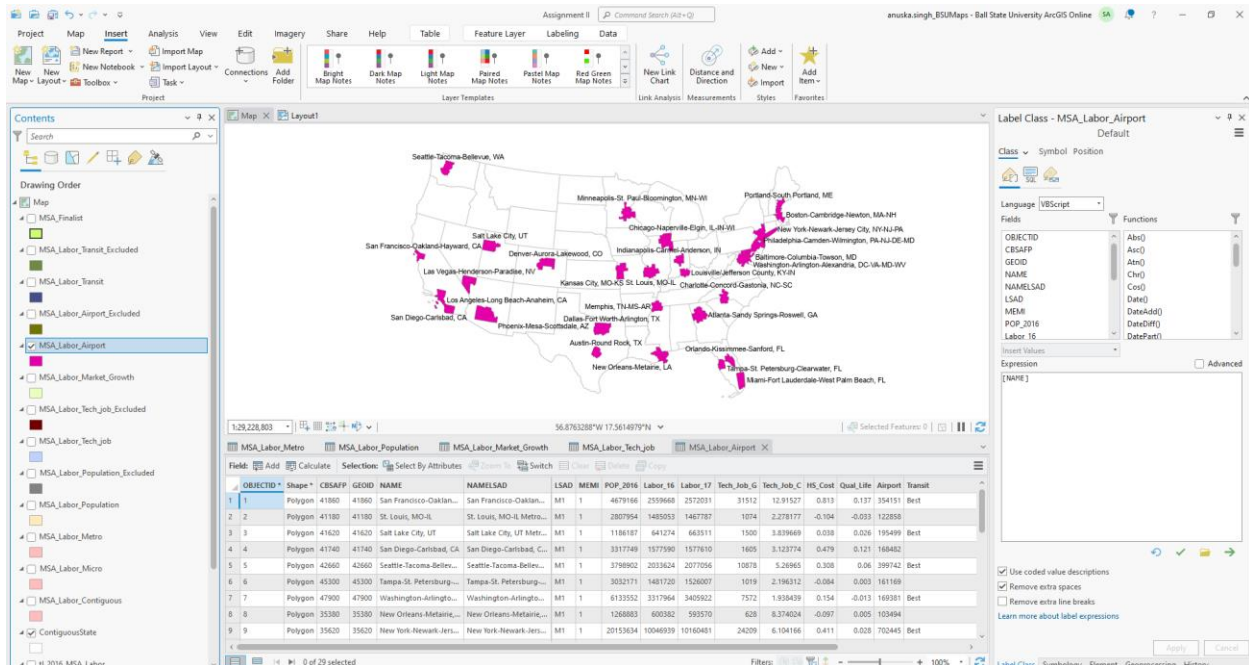
4. Fourth Criteria: Airport

How many MSAs are selected by the above criteria?

- There are 29 MSAs selected by the airport criteria.

Compare your selection of MSAs with the finalist MSAs on page 1. In this step, which MSAs are not included in your analysis result, and why do you think they are excluded? Explain.

- There are 25 MSAs excluded in the analysis result:
 - Raleigh, NC Metro Area
 - Rochester, NY Metro Area
 - Richmond, VA Metro Area
 - Riverside-San Bernardino-Ontario, CA Metro Area
 - Sacramento--Roseville--Arden-Arcade, CA Metro Area
 - San Jose-Sunnyvale-Santa Clara, CA Metro Area
 - San Antonio-New Braunfels, TX Metro Area
 - Tucson, AZ Metro Area
 - Virginia Beach-Norfolk-Newport News, VA-NC Metro Area
 - Nashville-Davidson--Murfreesboro--Franklin, TN Metro Area
 - Oklahoma City, OK Metro Area
 - Pittsburgh, PA Metro Area
 - Portland-Vancouver-Hillsboro, OR-WA Metro Area
 - Providence-Warwick, RI-MA Metro Area
 - Detroit-Warren-Dearborn, MI Metro Area
 - Milwaukee-Waukesha-West Allis, WI Metro Area
 - Grand Rapids-Wyoming, MI Metro Area
 - Hartford-West Hartford-East Hartford, CT Metro Area
 - Houston-The Woodlands-Sugar Land, TX Metro Area
 - Jacksonville, FL Metro Area
 - Birmingham-Hoover, AL Metro Area
 - Buffalo-Cheektowaga-Niagara Falls, NY Metro Area
 - Cincinnati, OH-KY-IN Metro Area
 - Cleveland-Elyria, OH Metro Area
 - Columbus, OH Metro Area



The MSAs listed above were excluded because they did not meet the criteria of having a commercial flight flow of over 100,000. They might be excluded due to following reasons:

- a. These MSAs may not have the required volume of commercial flights, indicating lower connectivity to major cities which is critical for Amazon Headquarters' needs.
- b. Some of these MSAs might be close to international airports, but the airports themselves might not meet the threshold for commercial flight flow specified in the criteria.

5. Fifth Criteria: Transit and the commuter population

How many MSAs are selected by the above criteria?

- There are 16 MSAs selected by the transit and the commuter population criteria.

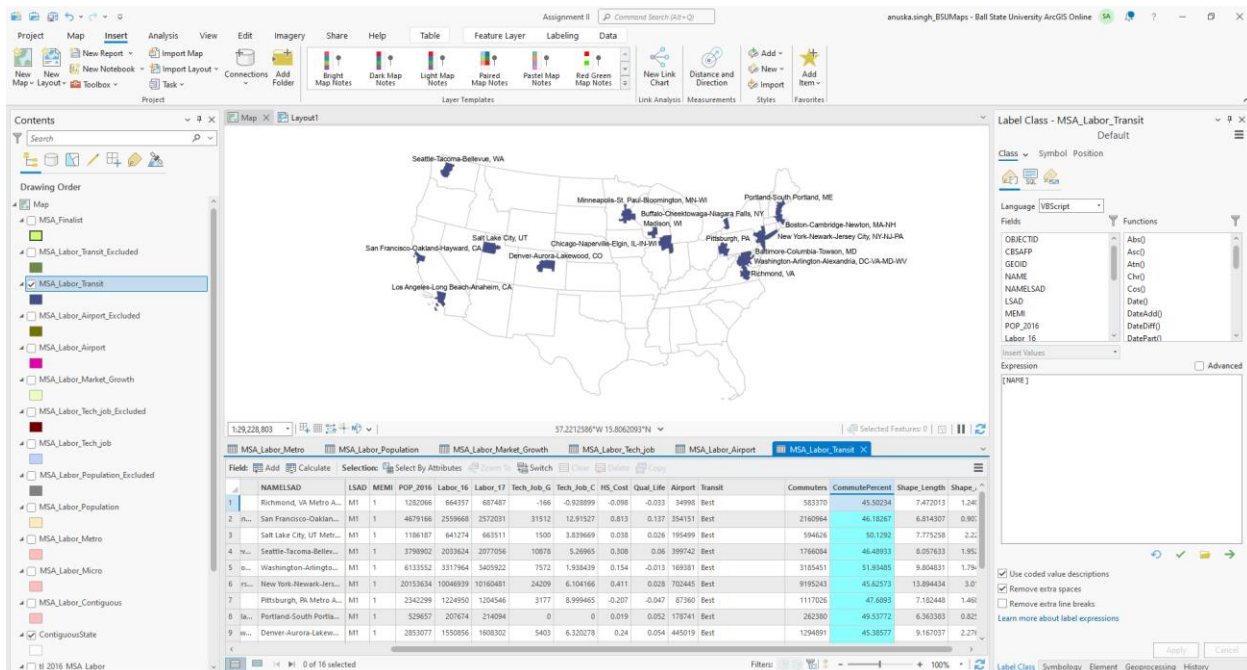
Compare your selection of MSAs with the finalist MSAs on page 1. In this step, which MSAs are not included in your analysis result, and why do you think they are excluded? Explain.

- There are 39 MSAs excluded in the analysis result:
 - o Raleigh, NC Metro Area
 - o Rochester, NY Metro Area
 - o Riverside-San Bernardino-Ontario, CA Metro Area
 - o Sacramento--Roseville--Arden-Arcade, CA Metro Area
 - o San Jose-Sunnyvale-Santa Clara, CA Metro Area
 - o St. Louis, MO-IL Metro Area
 - o San Antonio-New Braunfels, TX Metro Area
 - o San Diego-Carlsbad, CA Metro Area
 - o Tampa-St. Petersburg-Clearwater, FL Metro Area
 - o Tucson, AZ Metro Area
 - o Virginia Beach-Norfolk-Newport News, VA-NC Metro Area
 - o Nashville-Davidson--Murfreesboro--Franklin, TN Metro Area
 - o New Orleans-Metairie, LA Metro Area
 - o Oklahoma City, OK Metro Area
 - o Orlando-Kissimmee-Sanford, FL Metro Area
 - o Philadelphia-Camden-Wilmington, PA-NJ-DE-MD Metro Area
 - o Phoenix-Mesa-Scottsdale, AZ Metro Area
 - o Portland-Vancouver-Hillsboro, OR-WA Metro Area
 - o Providence-Warwick, RI-MA Metro Area
 - o Detroit-Warren-Dearborn, MI Metro Area
 - o Louisville/Jefferson County, KY-IN Metro Area
 - o Memphis, TN-MS-AR Metro Area
 - o Miami-Fort Lauderdale-West Palm Beach, FL Metro Area
 - o Milwaukee-Waukesha-West Allis, WI Metro Area

- Grand Rapids-Wyoming, MI Metro Area
- Hartford-West Hartford-East Hartford, CT Metro Area
- Houston-The Woodlands-Sugar Land, TX Metro Area
- Indianapolis-Carmel-Anderson, IN Metro Area
- Jacksonville, FL Metro Area
- Kansas City, MO-KS Metro Area
- Las Vegas-Henderson-Paradise, NV Metro Area
- Atlanta-Sandy Springs-Roswell, GA Metro Area
- Austin-Round Rock, TX Metro Area
- Birmingham-Hoover, AL Metro Area
- Charlotte-Concord-Gastonia, NC-SC Metro Area
- Cincinnati, OH-KY-IN Metro Area
- Cleveland-Elyria, OH Metro Area
- Columbus, OH Metro Area
- Dallas-Fort Worth-Arlington, TX Metro Area

These MSAs may have been excluded due to the following reasons:

- Many of these areas may have commuter populations below 45%, indicating lower reliance on public transit or less favorable commuting conditions.
- Some regions might not have been classified with a 'Best' transit system, impacting their eligibility.
- Certain cities may not meet the size or density requirements necessary for Amazon's site selection criteria, focusing on larger urban areas with robust labor markets and amenities.



6. Final Criteria: Quality of life

The top five MSAs under the criteria of quality of life are:

- Cape Coral-Fort Myers, FL Metro Area
- San Francisco-Oakland-Hayward, CA Metro Area
- Santa Maria-Santa Barbara, CA Metro Area
- Salinas, CA Metro Area
- San Diego-Carlsbad, CA Metro Area

❖ Select the top 5 finalists MSAs and justify your selection.

Considering all the criteria, the top five finalists MSAs, I selected are:

1. Cape Coral-Fort Myers, FL Metro Area:

Justification: Because of its booming population growth and reduced cost of living, this MSA offers a unique draw for enterprises seeking to expand. It is a desirable location for potential employees because of the strong emphasis on outdoor recreation and community service, which complements the high standard of living.

Data Source: [Cape Coral, FL](#)

2. San Francisco-Oakland-Hayward, CA Metro Area:

Justification: This region is a desirable one for Amazon's expansion since it has a workforce that is well educated, a thriving tech sector, and an abundance of venture money. Although housing costs are high, this challenge is lessened by the general standard of living and cultural attractions.

Data Source: [San Francisco, Workforce](#)

3. New York-Newark-Jersey City, NY-NJ-PA Metro Area:

Justification: The area of New York, Newark, and Jersey City is a strong candidate for Amazon's expansion because of its remarkable accessibility to a large customer base and a diverse economy that is concentrated on finance, media, technology, and logistics. The selection criteria can also establish this sector as a powerful competitor. The robust public transit system, vast transportation network, and main international airports enhance logistical efficiency and align nicely with Amazon's operational requirements. The metro area is desirable for Amazon's development due to its vibrant economy, a wealth of cultural attractions, and business opportunities.

Data Source: [New-York, NJ](#)

4. Los Angeles-Long Beach-Anaheim, CA Metro Area:

Justification: The Los Angeles, Long Beach, and Anaheim metropolitan area offers a good standard of living because of its diverse economy and significant advances in e-commerce, technology, and entertainment. The extensive selection criteria of population, market growth, tech job, airport and transit make it potentially quite competitive. By strategically utilizing the region's

strong economic base, Amazon can increase operational efficiency and development potential by taking advantage of the local tech ecosystem and workforce strengths in Los Angeles, Long Beach, and Anaheim.

Data Source: [Los Angeles, CA Metro Area](#)

5. Denver-Aurora-Lakewood, CO Metro Area:

Justification: The selection criteria, which include population size, labor market strength, market expansion, and more than 100,000 commercial flight movements, have made the Denver-Aurora-Lakewood metropolitan area a desirable option with a high standard of living. This region boasts a robust economy with noteworthy advancements in the fields of sustainable energy, healthcare, and technology. The economic opportunities and advantages in terms of quality of life in this area, even with the rising cost of housing, make it an attractive choice for Amazon's expansion.

Data Source: [US Bureau of Labor Statistics](#)

MSA	Housing Cost	Weight	Quality of Life	Weight	Total
Cape Coral-Fort Myers, FL	0	0.7	65607	1.5	98410.5
San Francisco-Oakland-Hayward, CA	0.813		0.137		0.7746
Los Angeles-Long Beach-Anaheim, CA	0.45		0.081		0.4365
New York-Newark-Jersey City, NY-NJ-PA	0.411		0.028		0.3297
Denver-Aurora-Lakewood, CO	0.24		0.054		0.249

Conclusion: ***The San Francisco-Oakland-Hayward, CA Metro Area*** has unmatched benefits in terms of labor, creativity, and economic vibrancy, which is why I believe it to be the best location for Amazon's headquarters. This area, which is home to Silicon Valley, one of the world's most successful tech hubs, is known worldwide for being a tech powerhouse. A consistent supply of top talent is ensured by the highly educated workforce, which is fueled by esteemed universities like UC Berkeley and Stanford University. This is especially true in sectors that are essential to Amazon's growth, such software development, artificial intelligence, and data analytics. The Bay Area's burgeoning venture capital scene fosters innovation and entrepreneurial endeavors by providing a thriving ecosystem that is perfectly matched with Amazon's strategic goals.

In addition, the San Francisco Bay Area provides a great standard of living due to its many recreational options, vibrant cultural scene, and generally mild weather. Even with the high cost of living, the area is a great place for a large corporation like Amazon because of its many advantages, which include population size, labor market strength, market expansion, more than 100,000 commercial flight movements, excellent public transit, and close proximity to important markets. By settling on the San Francisco-Oakland-Hayward metro area, Amazon will be able to take advantage of the robust economic base, creative energy, and highly qualified labor pool of the area, all of which will help to improve its operational efficiency and prospects for expansion.

AMAZON HEADQUATER IN THE UNITED STATES

